

.com:8000).

13.4.3 Podcasting

Podcasting, unlike Mercora or SHOUTcast, requires that you do have a Web site where you can host your audio files. A “podcast” refers both to the content and mode of delivery, and is usually used for audio talk shows and less for music distribution. While the file format can be any audio file format such as MP3 or WAV, the delivery of the podcast is where you see the difference. Podcasts are normally delivered via the RSS or Atom syndication formats, which enable your listener population to subscribe to your RSS or Atom feeds and listen to your talk show as and when they are posted. Podcasting involves the following steps:

1. Creating your podcast audio file

The first step in podcasting is to create your audio content. You can use Audacity or any of the other tools we have reviewed in the earlier chapters to create your audio talk show. Record your audio and add any music effects you wish to use. Once done, save your audio file as an MP3 and note down the file size in bytes. To get the file size, right-click on the MP3 file and select Properties. For example, if your system shows the file size as “3.89 MB (4,078,961 bytes)”, you should note down 4078961 without the commas.

2. Create the RSS Feed File

The RSS feed file is actually a text file in the XML format. Similar to HTML, you will need to use tags to specify the various parameters of your RSS Feed. Use Notepad to copy the below code and modify according to your requirements.

```
<?xml version="1.0"?>
  <rss version="2.0">
    <channel>

      <title>Digit Podcast</title>
      <link>http://www.digitpodcast.com/mypodcast.mp3</link>
      <description>My first podcast</description>
```